FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

PASSAGE PLANNING

Procedure

MV Seagull | UVI: 425689 | Class 2D, 2E

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

Document Number:	FUS-SMS-SGL-05K
Revision:	01
Date:	7 July 2026
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Approved By:	Kirby Hamilton
Vessel:	MV Seagull (UVI 425689)

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Revision History

Rev	Date	Author	Description	Approved
01	7 July 2026	M. Hilder	Initial issue	K. Hamilton

Approval

Role	Name	Date
Author	Matthew Hilder	7 July 2026
Reviewed	Belinda Brooks	7 July 2026
Approved	Kirby Hamilton	7 July 2026

Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the requirements for the preparation and use of passage plans for MV Seagull.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)(l). International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea, 1972 (COLREGs). NSCV C7C (Navigation Equipment).

1.2 Vessel Particulars

MV Seagull is a 6.50 m aluminium landing barge with a drop-down bow ramp, classified Class 2D, 2E (UVI 425689), powered by a single Yamaha F150XD outboard engine.

2. WHEN A PASSAGE PLAN IS REQUIRED

A passage plan shall be prepared before every voyage. The level of detail shall be proportionate to the complexity of the voyage. For routine, short-duration operations within a familiar operational area (e.g. transit within a known port or river), a brief mental or verbal passage plan communicated to the crew is acceptable provided the master considers and addresses the key elements listed in Section 4.

A written or charted passage plan is required for any of the following:

(a) Any voyage to an unfamiliar area or a new work site.

(b) Any voyage that involves crossing a coastal bar.

(c) Any voyage that involves transiting through a Traffic Separation Scheme or Vessel Traffic Service area for the first time on that day.

(d) Any voyage in conditions of restricted visibility.

(e) Any voyage exceeding 2 hours duration.

(f) When directed by the East Coast Operations Superintendent or the designated person.

3. RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1 Master

The master is responsible for preparing or approving the passage plan before departure. The master shall brief all crew on the passage plan, including the intended route, hazards, weather, tidal conditions, and any port or waterway regulations that apply.

3.2 Crew

Crew shall be familiar with the passage plan and shall alert the master to any changes in conditions or hazards observed during the voyage.

4. PASSAGE PLAN ELEMENTS

The passage plan shall consider and address the following elements as applicable:

4.1 Appraisal

(a) Weather forecast — check the Bureau of Meteorology (BOM) marine forecast for the operational area before departure. Assess wind, swell, sea state, visibility, and any warnings.

(b) Tidal information — check tide times and heights for the operational area. Consider tidal streams and currents.

(c) Navigational hazards — identify shallow water, rocks, reefs, restricted areas, cable zones, and any temporary hazards (e.g. marine events, dredging operations).

(d) Traffic — assess expected commercial and recreational traffic density for the time of day and area.

(e) Port and waterway regulations — confirm any speed restrictions, exclusion zones, reporting requirements, or VTS procedures for the area (refer FUS-SMS-SGL-05J Radio Watch for VHF channels).

4.2 Planning

(a) Route — identify the intended route from departure to arrival, including waypoints where course changes are required.

(b) Safe speed — determine the appropriate speed for each leg of the voyage considering weather, visibility, traffic, and waterway regulations.

(c) Depth — confirm adequate water depth along the route for the vessel's draught, accounting for tidal state.

(d) Safe havens — identify safe anchorages, harbours, or refuges along the route in case of emergency or deteriorating weather.

(e) Fuel — confirm adequate fuel for the planned voyage plus a minimum 30% reserve.

(f) Communications — confirm VHF channels for the operational area and any reporting requirements (refer FUS-SMS-SGL-05J).

(g) Vessel movements — Before departure, check the published daily vessel movements schedule for the operating port(s) (Port Authority of NSW) and plan around scheduled large-vessel arrivals, departures, and berth shifts. Scheduled times change at short notice — monitor Sydney VTS on VHF Ch 13 and Botany Bay VTS on 12 for movement updates while underway.

4.3 Execution

(a) Brief crew on the passage plan before departure.

(b) Monitor the vessel's position continuously using the chart plotter and echo sounder.

(c) Maintain a proper lookout at all times (COLREGs Rule 5).

(d) Adjust the plan as conditions change — the passage plan is a guide, not a rigid instruction. The master shall deviate from the plan whenever safety requires it.

4.4 Monitoring

(a) Continuously compare the vessel's actual track against the planned route.

(b) Monitor weather conditions and compare against the forecast.

(c) Monitor fuel consumption against the plan.

(d) If conditions deteriorate or the plan is no longer appropriate, reassess and amend the plan or return to port.

5. OPERATIONAL AREAS

The following areas are authorised under the Certificate of Operation for MV Seagull:

(a) NSW partially smooth waters (Class 2D).

(b) NSW smooth waters (Class 2E).

(c) New South Wales only (Certificate of Survey or other exemption required outside NSW).

The master shall confirm the applicable water class designation (and corresponding weather limits per FUS-SMS-SGL-06K Adverse Weather) before departure.

6. RECORDS

Written passage plans (where prepared) shall be retained in the vessel logbook or SMS folder. For routine voyages where a verbal passage plan is used, the key elements (departure point, destination, route, weather conditions, and persons onboard) are captured in the QR code pre-start form and the vessel logbook.

7. REFERENCES

FUS-SMS-SGL-05F Navigation and Watchkeeping

FUS-SMS-SGL-05J Radio Watch

FUS-SMS-SGL-06K Adverse Weather

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)(l)